Nigeria E-Commerce CRM

SMS & Multi-Channel Communications Architecture Guide

Executive Briefing
Platform: crm.olistores.com.ng
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1. Executive Summary

Customer communication in Nigerian Cash-on-Delivery (COD) e-commerce is the single most critical driver of order confirmation rates and delivery fulfillment. Incomplete orders (abandoned carts), unconfirmed dispatches, and unreachable buyers directly increase returns (Return-to-Origin / RTO), which rapidly consumes shipping capital.

This briefing outlines the recommended, cost-effective infrastructure for our CRM. We utilize a **Smart Hybrid Architecture**: combining **Zero-Cost WhatsApp Automation** for marketing and cart recovery with **High-Reliability DND-Bypass SMS** via **Termii** for urgent delivery alerts.

> **Financial Advantage:** By making WhatsApp our primary automated channel (**₦0.00 per message**) and using SMS exclusively for high-urgency notifications (e.g. rider arriving at the door), communication costs drop by over **85%** while maintaining a **98%+ delivery rate**.

2. The Nigerian SMS Reality: Why Standard Bulk SMS Fails

In Nigeria, the Nigerian Communications Commission (NCC) mandates a **Do-Not-Disturb (DND)** policy across MTN, Airtel, Glo, and 9mobile. Over 40% of active mobile lines in Nigeria have DND enabled by default.

- **Standard / Generic Bulk SMS (₦2.50 – ₦3.50):** Filtered out and silently dropped by telecom switches on any number with active DND. Using this route for delivery confirmations results in customers never knowing their order is on the way.
- **Transactional / DND-Bypass Route (₦4.00 – ₦5.00):** Delivers through corporate financial routing pipelines (the same channels used by Nigerian banks for debit/credit alerts). Delivers in 2–4 seconds to 100% of lines regardless of DND settings.

3. Gateway Provider Comparison

GATEWAY PROVIDER	COST PER SMS	DND DELIVERY RATE	PAYMENT CURRENCY	RECOMMENDATION
Termii	**₦4.00 – ₦5.00**	99% (DND BYPASS)	Nigerian Naira (Paystack / Transfer)	**Recommended (#1 in Nigeria)**
Sendchamp	₦4.50 – ₦5.50	98% (DND BYPASS)	Nigerian Naira (Card / Transfer)	Good secondary alternative
Generic Bulk SMS	₦2.80 – ₦3.50	45% – 60% (FAILS ON DND)	Nigerian Naira	Not suitable for order dispatch
Twilio (International)	~$0.06 (**~₦90.00**)	VARIABLE	US Dollars ($)	**Avoid (Too expensive for NG)**

4. The Profit-Maximizing Hybrid Communications Playbook

Rather than relying solely on SMS, the CRM implements a multi-channel operational workflow:

A **Primary Channel: Automated WhatsApp Gateway (₦0.00 Cost)**

Used for marketing broadcasts (up to 2,000+ buyers), abandoned cart 1-click checkout recovery, and full visual invoices. Delivered from your registered business phone with 98% open rates and instant interactive customer replies.

B **Secondary Channel: Termii Transactional DND SMS (₦4.50 Cost)**

Used for operational, time-critical alerts where internet data might be turned off on the buyer's phone. For example: "*Hello {{customer_name}}, rider is arriving at your address in 20 minutes with Order #{{order_number}}. Please have ₦{{amount}} cash or transfer ready.*"

5. Step-by-Step Setup Guide to Activate Live SMS

The CRM codebase is already fully programmed for Termii. It requires only 4 simple steps to activate live dispatch:

1 **Create Free Account**

Visit **https://termii.com** and complete standard 2-minute merchant registration.

2 **Fund Wallet in Naira**

Top up **₦2,000 to ₦5,000** using Paystack, debit card, or bank transfer (~400–1,000 SMS).

3 **Retrieve API Key**

Go to **Settings** → **API Token** in your Termii dashboard and copy the API Key string.

4 **Add to Production Env**

In Render Environment: set `TERMII_API_KEY`, `TERMII_SENDER_ID = N-ALERT`, `TERMII_CHANNEL = dnd`.

Sender ID Note: You can start immediately today using the shared transactional sender ID `N-ALERT` with zero wait time. Once operational, you can optionally upload your CAC registration to Termii to request your custom branded alphanumeric Sender ID (e.g. `OLISTORES`).

6. WhatsApp Multi-Device Gateway Best Practice

WhatsApp uses an encrypted, single-client WebSocket protocol. For 100% connection stability:

- **Production Server Only:** Link your WhatsApp business phone strictly on the live deployed CRM (**crm.olistores.com.ng**). Do not run a duplicate server on localhost at the same time, as WhatsApp automatically disconnects duplicate server instances.
- **Anti-Ban Safe Pacing:** Our built-in background worker applies human-like randomized delays (6–12s) and 25-message cooling pauses, safeguarding your WhatsApp number from automated spam flags during bulk 2,000-contact broadcasts.